

Building materials

Buildings have to last a long time. The materials construction workers use must be strong and able to resist all types of weather.



Glass windows let light in, but keep out the wind, rain, and cold.

Hard bricks make strong walls that can carry a lot of weight.

Mortar is a mixture of cement, sand, and water. It sticks bricks together.

Cardboard is made from wood pulp, too. In fact, the book you are reading comes from a tree!

Wood

Wood comes from trees. It can be cut to different lengths and hammered or screwed together to make furniture, such as this table.

Paper

Tiny chips of wood are cooked with water, until they become mushy and form a pulp. The pulp is then spread out thinly and dried to make sheets of paper.

Houses around the world

All over the world, people use different materials to build their homes, depending on what's available nearby.



Mud hut

This hut is made from mud and straw.



Log cabin

This home has wooden walls and shingles.



Igloo

An igloo is made of thick blocks of snow.